

Eleventh Sunday in Ordinary Time

Year A

PC-S35-A

Textual unit	Text / citation
Introductory Rites	
Entrance Antiphon	cf. Ps. 27:7, 9
Collect	<i>Deus, in te sperantium fortitudo</i>
Liturgy of the Word	
First Reading	Exod. 19:2–6a
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 100:1–2, 3, 5; response 3c
Second Reading	Rom. 5:6–11
Gospel Acclamation	Mark 1:15
Gospel	Matt. 9:36–10:8
Liturgy of the Eucharist	
Prayer over Offerings	<i>Deus, qui humani generis utramque substantiam</i>
Communion Antiphon	A: Ps. 27:4; B: John 17:11
Prayer after Communion	<i>Haec tua . . . sacra communio . . . unionem praesignat</i>

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	Israel reaches Sinai and receives a covenant vocation; Jesus sees harassed crowds, names the Twelve, and sends them; Paul proclaims reconciliation accomplished while humanity was weak and hostile.
Allegorical	The Lord of the harvest gathers a covenant people in Christ. The Church receives mission and sacramental unity from him; she does not own the grace she gives.
Moral	Compassion must become prayer, obedient labor, gratuitous service, and action sustained by grace. Mission rejects both self-sufficiency and covetous possession of holy gifts.
Anagogical	Reconciliation promises salvation through Christ's risen life and perfected unity; unselected Communion A adds the image of lasting dwelling in God's house.

The Propers: Themes and Movement

Governing account: a people received, reconciled, and sent

The Lectionary joins Israel's covenant vocation to Christ's compassionate commissioning of the Twelve, while Romans supplies an independent apostolic proclamation of reconciliation. The Missal frames this hearing with grace for action, bodily and spiritual renewal, and sacramental unity; the resulting architecture is source-grounded synthesis, not a claim that every text was composed for Year A.

Called by grace → gathered as God's people → sent from Christ's compassion → renewed in Communion

1. Need becomes petition (*Entrance, Collect*)

The Entrance does not begin with institutional confidence but with a plea to be heard and helped. The Collect likewise acknowledges mortal frailty and asks grace for both willing and doing. Mission therefore begins as dependence: the Church cannot make herself the Lord's harvest, manufacture vocation, or turn resolve into holy action apart from God.

2. Election becomes vocation (*First Reading, Psalm, Gospel*)

Exodus first announces what God has done in bearing Israel from bondage; only then does it name covenant obedience and priestly vocation. Psalm 100 answers with belonging and grateful service. Matthew's official correlation does not erase Israel: Jesus sends the Twelve first to Israel, and the mission remains governed by the Messiah of Israel and Lord of the harvest.

3. Compassion becomes gratuitous mission (*Acclamation, Gospel, Second Reading*)

Jesus' compassion sees crowds as harassed and abandoned, then commands prayer and gives authority. Chrysostom stresses that the harvest was already prepared and remains Christ's. "Without cost" disciplines pride and covetousness. Romans independently supplies the deepest prior gift: Christ acts for the weak, sinful, and hostile, so Christian service gives from reconciliation already received.

4. Offering becomes renewal and unity (*Prayer over Offerings, Communion, Prayer after Communion*)

The Prayer over the Offerings holds body and mind together: ordinary food sustains creaturely life and Sacrament renews it. Communion may voice desire for God's house or Christ's prayer for unity. The concluding prayer names unity as both sign and effect. These shared Week XI texts can frame Year A mission, but they were not proved historically designed for its readings.

Guardrails

Israel: covenant language may not support contempt or simple replacement. **Ministry:** gratuitous grace does not deny lawful material support, but it forbids treating divine gifts as personal property. **Relationship:** Romans remains an independent semi-continuous strand rather than evidence of a single compositional plan.

Theological and Spiritual Synthesis

The variable texts move from divine initiative to a received vocation. God bears Israel and calls a priestly people; Christ sees the crowds, names the Twelve, and sends them from his own compassion; Paul proclaims reconciliation given while humanity was weak and hostile. The Church's mission is therefore participation in grace already received, never possession of a gift she originated.

That gift calls for prayer, obedient labor, gratuitous service, and action sustained by grace. The offering and post-Communion prayers join bodily and spiritual renewal to ecclesial unity, while the two Communion antiphons place that unity within desire for God's dwelling or Christ's own prayer. The horizon is salvation through the risen life of Christ and perfected communion in God.

Dimension	Appointed anchors	Source-grounded synthesis	Limit
Christological	Rom. 5:6–11; Matt. 9:36–10:8; Mark 1:15	Christ reconciles enemies before they can merit it, sees the crowds with compassion, and remains the Lord who sends workers into his harvest. Mission participates in his prior gift.	Romans is a semi-continuous strand; the table does not claim that the human authors or formulary compiler designed one literary sequence.
Ecclesial	Exod. 19:2–6a; Ps. 100; Gospel; Communion B; Prayer after Communion	A people first borne by God receives covenant vocation, apostolic mission, and sacramental unity rather than producing or possessing them.	Israel's prior election must be preserved, and the John 17 Communion antiphon is an unselected alternative.
Sacramental	Prayer over Offerings; Communion A/B; Prayer after Communion	Created nourishment and sacramental renewal join, according to the Communion path, desire for God's dwelling or Christ's prayer for unity; the final prayer names unity as sign and effect.	Communion A and B are documented but unselected; the Week XI orations serve every Sunday cycle, and sacramental renewal promises no automatic bodily cure.
Moral and eschatological	Entrance; Collect; Gospel; Romans; Communion A	Dependence becomes prayer, grace-enabled action, gratuitous service, and hope of salvation through Christ's risen life and final dwelling with God.	Communion A is unselected; "without cost" rejects ownership and exploitation of grace, not lawful support for ministry, and present mission is not yet perfected communion.

The Propers: Detailed Commentary

The petitioning assembly (*Entrance, Collect*)

Psalms 27 lets need and desire occupy the same prayer: the threatened speaker asks for God's hearing and help while seeking one thing, life in God's presence. At the Entrance only the plea is appointed; the house-of-God verse belongs to Communion option A. Their common psalm creates a genuine textual arc without proving that both branches were enacted.

The Collect's Latin identity places God himself as the strength of those who hope in him. Its anthropology is neither pessimistic nor voluntarist. Human willing and acting are real, but frail; grace enables the creature to intend and perform what pleases God.

A treasured people under the Lord of the harvest (*Exodus, Psalm, Matthew*)

Exodus 19 follows liberation and precedes ratification. Israel is not selected because it achieved holiness; God first carried and gathered the people. "Possession," "kingdom of priests," and "holy nation" therefore name gift and task together. Catholic reception applies this vocabulary to the Church in Christ while preserving Israel's election and refusing a crude identity swap.

Psalm 100 turns the covenant declaration into congregational response. The sheep do not make their shepherd, and the people do not create their own belonging. Yet service is active and joyful. The psalm holds together creaturehood, covenant identity, worship, and enduring divine fidelity.

Matthew's Jesus first sees. Compassion is not a decorative feeling but the source of prayer, naming, authority, and sending. The mixed images of shepherdless flock and abundant harvest both keep agency with Christ. Chrysostom notes that prophetic labor has preceded the apostles; they reap what grace has prepared, while Christ is expressly the harvest's Lord. Mission therefore resists both despair, as though the field were empty, and triumphalism, as though the workers owned it.

The Twelve are individually named before they are sent. Their mission is corporate and personal, authorized yet bounded. The initial restriction to Israel belongs to this stage of Matthew's narrative and makes Christian anti-Judaism especially incoherent. The final command to give without cost recalls that authority, healing, and proclamation are received gifts. It rules out ownership and exploitation, not the wider New Testament's lawful support of ministers.

The independent apostolic foundation (*Romans*)

Romans 5 does not function as a hidden allegory of Exodus or the Twelve. Paul intensifies humanity's condition: weak, ungodly, sinful, and hostile. Christ's death does not answer human worthiness but creates reconciliation. Chrysostom's direct exposition emphasizes the sequence from enemies reconciled through death to a stronger hope of salvation through Christ's living power.

This strand changes the spiritual posture of mission without pretending to explain why the Lectionary paired every text. Workers are first beneficiaries. "Without cost" can therefore be heard under Romans' priority of gift as a source-grounded synthesis: the Church gives what she did not originate, to persons she may not classify as deserving or undeserving.

Kingdom acclamation (*Acclamation*)

Mark's verse is acclamatory: it announces fulfilled time, nearness of the Kingdom, conversion, and faith in order to welcome Christ about to speak. It should not be expanded into another homily before the Gospel. Its Kingdom language nonetheless clarifies the mission's object: the Twelve announce divine reign, not themselves.

Gift and sacramental unity (*Prayer over Offerings, Communion, Prayer after Communion*)

The Prayer over the Offerings compares the created nourishment of bodily nature with sacramental renewal, then asks aid for both body and mind. This refuses a spirituality that treats embodiment as disposable. It also prevents an automatic promise of present bodily cure: the prayer concerns God’s sustaining and sanctifying gift within the Church’s sacramental horizon.

Communion option A continues Psalm 27’s movement from plea to dwelling. Option B takes Christ’s prayer that his disciples be one. The Prayer after Communion makes unity more than sentiment: reception signifies it and petitions its effect. Division cannot be healed by suppressing truth or justice, and sacramental reception is not magic; nevertheless, unity is God’s gift before it becomes the Church’s ethical work.

The Propers: Interpretive Possibilities

Editorial status

The following are original editorial or AI-generated possibilities. They are attributed to none of the cited authorities and claim no historical compositional intent. Each begins from appointed anchors and remains subordinate to the books’ actual relationships.

From counted names to unpossessed gifts. (*Gospel*) The Gospel names each apostle yet ends by denying ownership of grace. This can support formation that joins personal responsibility to institutional humility. The limit is important: a named office is real authority, not merely a metaphor, and “free” ministry does not erase just material obligations.

Unity as missionary truthfulness. (*Communion B, Prayer after Communion*) Communion option B and the concluding prayer may illuminate the credibility of a Church sent by one Lord. Unity makes mission intelligible when it is communion in truth and charity. This possibility belongs specifically to Communion alternative B and must not imply that conflict should be concealed or victims silenced.

One care for body and soul. (*Prayer over Offerings, Gospel*) The offering prayer’s account of bodily nourishment and sacramental renewal may guide a mission that joins proclamation, healing care, and respect for material need. It does not identify medicine with sacrament, promise miraculous cure, or reduce salvation to social provision.

Appendix: Scriptural and Historical Coordinates

Canonical order governs; composition and narrated events are distinguished, while inherited attributions and modern historical judgments are reported without pretending that uncertainty has disappeared.

Textual unit / alternative	Citation	Location	Date
First Reading	Exod. 19:2–6a	Israel; exact place of final Pentateuchal formation unresolved	First-millennium BC final form; precise date unresolved
Narrated event	Exod. 19:1–6a	Sinai wilderness	After deliverance from Egypt; exact historical date unresolved
Jewish and Christian tradition associates the Pentateuch with Moses. Modern Catholic study recognizes extended transmission and literary formation; the precise date and geographical identification of Sinai remain disputed. The scene stands after deliverance and before covenant ratification, addressing Israel as the people first borne by God and then called to covenant obedience.			
Entrance / Comm. A	Ps. 27:4, 7, 9	Israel; exact composition place unknown	Traditional Davidic attribution; historical date uncertain
The inherited heading attributes the psalm to David. Its movement from danger and petition to desire for God's house makes one psalm serve both the Entrance's plea and Communion's contemplative branch; this shared source is textual fact, not proof of one modern formulary design.			
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 100:1–2, 3, 5	Israel's worship; precise place unknown	Date and human author unknown
A thanksgiving psalm summons all lands to serve the Lord and confesses creaturely and covenant belonging. Its appointment after Exodus 19 makes "people" and "flock" the assembly's liturgical answer to election and vocation.			
Gospel	Matt. 9:36–10:8	Canonical Gospel: traditional Palestine; modern Antioch proposal uncertain	Traditionally early apostolic period; modern majority c. AD 80–90
Narrated event	Matt. 4:23; 9:35–10:8	Galilee; exact town unrecorded	Public ministry, c. AD 28–29
Ancient tradition identifies the Apostle Matthew writing for Jewish believers. Modern study usually dates the canonical Greek Gospel after AD 70. The narrated movement passes from Jesus' teaching and healing circuit to compassion, prayer for laborers, and the first commissioning of the named Twelve.			
Acclamation	Mark 1:15	Canonical Gospel: traditional Rome; modern place debated	Traditional AD 60s; modern proposals c. AD 65–70
Narrated event	Mark 1:14–15	Galilee	Opening ministry, c. AD 28
Tradition associates Mark with Peter's Roman preaching. The appointed verse condenses Jesus' opening proclamation of fulfilled time, near Kingdom, conversion, and faith; liturgically it welcomes the Gospel rather than becoming another reading.			
Comm. B	John 17:11	Canonical Gospel: traditional Ephesus; modern compositional history debated	Late first century in tradition and many modern judgments
Narrated event	John 13:1; 17:1–26	Jerusalem, final supper	c. AD 29–30
Tradition identifies the Apostle John and an Ephesian setting. The Communion branch takes a clause from Christ's prayer for his disciples' unity; it is an appointed alternative, not evidence that every celebration used this text.			
Second Reading	Rom. 5:6–11	Corinth, Achaia (present-day Greece), to churches at Rome	c. AD 56–58
Paul writes to mixed Jewish and Gentile house churches he has not yet visited. The passage moves from helplessness and enmity through Christ's death and reconciliation to confidence in salvation through his life. Its semi-continuous place in Romans remains primary.			

Appendix: Liturgical Resolution

Liturgical Instance

Field	Resolved liturgical instance
Formula and occurrence	PC-S35-A; Sunday Mass for the Eleventh Sunday in Ordinary Time; 14 June 2026; green.
Books and territory	<i>Roman Missal, Third Edition</i> , English for the United States (implemented 2011), and U.S. <i>Lectionary for Mass</i> , Second Typical Edition, Volume I, no. 91.
Calendar and cycle	General Roman Calendar as implemented in the United States; Sunday Year A.
Formulary and textual scope	Ordinary Time Week XI. Its shared audit owns the Missal formulary; this leaf owns the dated Year A composition and its two Communion-antiphon alternatives.

Branch Resolution

Branch ID	Authority and trigger	Status	Units affected	Resolution
communion-antiphon-psalm-27	Week XI formulary	Appointed alternative	Psalms 27 option	Documented, not selected
communion-antiphon-john-17	Week XI formulary	Appointed alternative	John 17 option	Documented, not selected

Appendix: Scope and Qualifications

Instance: instance/manifest.md. **Leaf composition audit:** propers/verified.md. **Canonical formulary owner:** ../shared/ordinary-time/weeks/11/propers/verified.md. **Research audit:** research/scope.md. **Coverage:** the complete formula, all named branches, every direct biblical passage, immediate literary contexts, direct Chrysostom reception of Matthew and Romans, Augustine on Psalm 100, and doctrinal illumination were studied. **Limits:** no exhaustive manuscript, untranslated-corpus, subscription-database, or proper-calendar survey is claimed. Complete U.S. English altar-book oration collation and independent theological review remain outstanding.

References

- USCCB, Eleventh Sunday in Ordinary Time, 14 June 2026, U.S. Lectionary 91; and 2026 Liturgical Calendar, accessed 2026-07-15.
- *Missale Romanum*, editio typica tertia (2002), p. 461; reimpressio emendata (2008); and *Roman Missal, Third Edition*, U.S. English edition implemented 2011. Exact source roles and collation limits are in the owner and leaf audits.
- Bishops' Conference of England and Wales, *Antiphonary: Excerpted from the Roman Missal* (ICEL, 2010), p. 72, used as official corroboration of the common ICEL antiphons, not as a substitute U.S. altar book.
- *General Instruction of the Roman Missal* 46–90; *General Introduction to the Lectionary* 65–69, 78–91, 93–110.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 32 on Matthew* and *Homily 9 on Romans*.
- St. Augustine, *Exposition on Psalm 100*.
- Second Vatican Council, *Lumen gentium* 9; *Catechism of the Catholic Church* 781–786.

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